37 Territory and Subsistence: A Preliminary Archaeobotanical and Landscape Approach to Ca' Nova di Albareto between the Bronze Age and Iron Age

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This study presents a preliminary investigation into the dynamics of territorial exploitation and subsistence strategies at the Ca' Nova di Albareto site between the Bronze Age and Iron Age. The site of Ca’ Nova di Albareto is located on a plateau near the rocky outcrop of Monte Chiaro in the upper Taro River valley, at an altitude of 700 meters. Occupation appears to date back to the Early Bronze Age, while the Middle Bronze Age phase is well documented by settlement traces such as post holes, hearths, and a probable dwelling structure. Traces of frequentation likely date to the second half of the Iron Age.

The research adopts an integrated methodological approach based on: (1) direct archaeobotanical analysis: study of plant macro-remains extracted from soil samples collected during the excavation campaigns conducted by the University of Bologna; (2) integration of previous data: synthesis and processing of documentation relating to pollen, plant macro-remains, charcoals and faunal remains; (3) spatial analysis of the territory: site catchment analysis and cost distance analysis; (4) land evaluation: assessment of agricultural potential and soil composition through consultation of maps.

The integration of these data aims to construct a potential model of the carrying capacity and land uses in the territory surrounding the site. The ultimate objective includes understanding the potential extension and nature of the settlement, inserting it into a broader interpretive framework relating to the network of relationships between the protohistoric settlements of the Apennines.